

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

FRIDAY, MAY 16, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 114

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Walmart said it plans** to raise prices this month and into the summer, when tariff-affected merchandise reaches its store shelves. **A1**
- ◆ **Meta delayed the** rollout of a flagship artificial-intelligence model, prompting insider concerns about the direction of its AI investments. **A1**
- ◆ **Powell said the Fed** was adjusting its policy-setting framework to account for changes in the inflation and interest-rate outlook following the 2020 pandemic. **A2**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed for a second straight session, with the S&P 500 and Dow rising 0.4% and 0.6%, respectively, and the Nasdaq falling 0.2%. **B10**
- ◆ **Trump chided Apple CEO** Tim Cook for the iPhone maker's plans to shift assembly of many U.S.-bound devices to India, reiterating his demand that the company bring manufacturing back to the U.S. **B1**
- ◆ **Coinbase said it refused** to pay a \$20 million ransom demand from cybercriminals who bribed the company's overseas customer-support agents to steal user data. **B1**
- ◆ **Chinese automaker** Geely reported record sales for the first quarter and net profit that more than tripled to the equivalent of \$786.6 million. **B2**
- ◆ **Deere forecast net** income in fiscal 2025 in a bracket between \$4.75 billion and \$5.5 billion, broadening the range of its guidance. **B3**
- ◆ **Siemens posted** better-than-expected revenue and net profit for its second quarter based on the strong performance of its industrial business. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump's bid to abolish** birthright citizenship prompted more than two hours of oral argument at the Supreme Court as justices wrestled with the propriety of federal judges blocking administration policies nationwide. **A1**
- ◆ **The Department of** Homeland Security is considering the creation of a reality television show in which migrants would compete for U.S. citizenship. **A4**
- ◆ **The president used** a stop at a U.S. military base in Qatar to highlight his role as commander in chief without articulating substantive policy on Iran, Gaza or Ukraine. **A7**
- ◆ **Donors are being offered** a "dedicated VIP experience" to several events Trump is planning with the U.S. military, including a military parade on June 14, his birthday. **A6**
- ◆ **U.S. negotiators** for the first time pitched a written nuclear proposal to their Iranian counterparts days before Trump said an agreement on the matter was close. **A7**
- ◆ **Homeland Security asked** the Pentagon to provide about 20,000 National Guardsmen to secure the border. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump shared poll results** with GOP Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene to discourage her from running for Senate in 2026. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** will drop recommendations that teenagers, children and pregnant women routinely get Covid-19 vaccines. **A3**
- ◆ **NJ Transit** workers went on strike, potentially disrupting commutes for 300,000 riders of the suburban railroad. **A3**

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Zelensky Arrives for Talks, but Putin Is a No-Show



SEDAR OZSOY/GETTY IMAGES

SOLO: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, waiting to speak to the media in Ankara, Turkey, on Thursday, authorized the first direct peace talks with Russia in three years. Russia's Vladimir Putin declined Zelensky's call that he attend in person. **A8**

Meta Delays Flagship AI Model, Sparking Concerns Internally

By MEGHAN BOBROWSKY AND SAM SCHECHNER

Meta is delaying the rollout of a flagship AI model, prompting internal concerns about the direction of its multibillion-dollar AI investments, people familiar with the matter said.

Company engineers are struggling to significantly improve the capabilities of its "Behemoth" large-language model, leading to staff questions about whether improve-

ments over prior versions are significant enough to justify public release, the people said.

Early in its development, Behemoth was internally slated for an April release to coincide with Meta's inaugural AI conference for developers. Meta put out two smaller models in its Llama AI model family ahead of the event, but later pushed an internal target for the larger Behemoth's release to June. Now, it has been delayed to fall or later.

Meta has previously drawn

praise for the speed with which it has caught up to rivals in the global AI arms race—spending billions of dollars along the way to develop the technology that powers chatbots on WhatsApp, Instagram and Facebook. Meta plans to spend up to \$72 billion in capital expenditures this year, much of which will be used to help realize Chief Executive Mark Zuckerberg's grand ambitions for AI.

Zuckerberg and other

Meta executives haven't publicly committed to a timeline for Behemoth.

The company could ultimately decide to release Behemoth sooner than expected, including by rolling out a more-limited version. But Meta engineers and researchers are concerned its performance wouldn't match public statements about its capabilities, the people said.

A Meta spokesman declined to comment.

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Court Mulls Injunctions In Cases on Birthright Citizenship

By JESS BRAVIN AND MARIAH TIMMS

WASHINGTON—President Trump's bid to abolish birthright citizenship sparked more than two hours of oral argument Thursday at the Supreme Court, where justices wrestled less with the legality of his decree than the propriety of federal judges blocking administration policies nationwide.

Three federal courts have blocked Trump's citizenship order, but the administration for now is asking the Supreme Court only to limit the scope of their injunctions to the named litigants in those cases. That procedural issue dominated the arguments, but the real-world implications formed the backdrop: potentially granting citizenship to children born to unauthorized migrants in some states, but denying it to those born in others, while litigation over the Constitution's meaning winds out over months or years.

Conservative justices focused on the growing modern-day approach of judges in single federal districts blocking a presidential policy for the entire U.S.

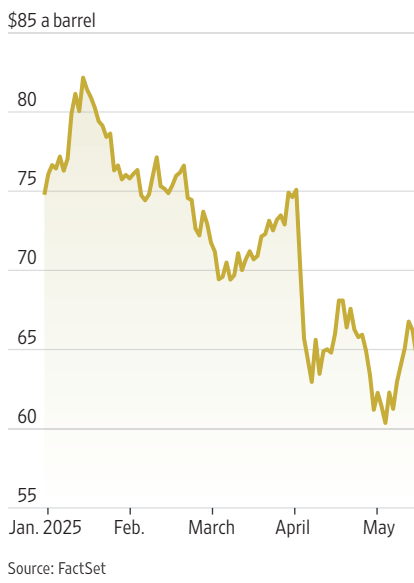
Justice Samuel Alito observed there are 680 federal district judges, and said that "sometimes they're wrong." Allowing a single one of them to freeze a presidential policy nationwide was a problem, he said. "A trial judge sitting up in that courtroom is the monarch of that realm," he said.

But liberals suggested the danger would be allowing the

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◆ **Seized migrants don't get** their day in court..... **A4**

Brent-crude futures prices, year to date



Source: FactSet

Iran Deal Talk Hits Oil Prices

Oil prices fell more than 3% Thursday as investors anticipated that a nuclear deal between the U.S. and Iran would entail easing sanctions on Iranian crude exports. President Trump said the U.S. is close to an agreement, after a written proposal was given to Iranian negotiators. **A7**

Air-Traffic Controller Shaken by Close Call

By ANDREW TANGEL

MALVERN, Pa.—Jonathan Stewart was into his fourth hour overseeing the planes flying near Newark, N.J., when he noticed two aircraft speeding nose-to-nose on his radar scope.

A business jet that had departed the Morristown airport was heading toward another small plane that had taken off from nearby Teterboro, a hub for corporate flying. A midair collision was potentially seconds away with planes flying at the same altitude.

The veteran air-traffic controller had been scribbling call-signs for the planes and flight information in a notebook, worried that radar and radio communication might fail as they had days earlier. After recognizing the unfolding conflict, he instructed the pilots to turn the planes away from each other, which they did.

But Stewart, 45 years old, was badly shaken. Hours after the May 4 incident, he fired off an email to Federal Aviation Administration managers, criticizing their leadership. "I take

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Bags of Cash From Drug Cartels Flood U.S. Banks

Chinese money launderers used Chase, Bank of America and Citibank branches

On a hazy Southern California morning, undercover police officers watched Jia-yong Yu step out of a Range Rover in a strip-mall parking lot and walk into a Chase bank with a black-leather backpack full of cash.

By Dylan Tokar, Justin Baer and Vipal Monga

At the teller window, Yu pulled out stacks of bills and waited while a woman fed them into a cash-counting machine. After Yu left, an officer asked the teller if he had deposited more than \$10,000, the threshold requiring banks to flag transactions to federal regulators.

More like \$100,000, the teller said. By then, Yu was already on his way to Chase

and Bank of America branches in Claremont, Calif., about 35 miles away.

Federal authorities allege that Yu worked for an underground banking network that bought dollars at a discount from Mexico's Sinaloa drug cartel and sold them at a premium, largely to Chinese nationals in the U.S.

The network allegedly handled some \$50 million in proceeds from drug trafficking over four years, depositing a portion of the tainted cash at ATMs and teller windows at major banks including Citibank in cities around Los Angeles County, according to federal prosecutors.

Similar money-laundering operations operate in plain sight around the U.S., hiding the staggering returns which

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They Splurged On the Vision Pro. A Year Later, It Still Hurts.

Apple's headset launched to great fanfare, but all these buyers got were dirty looks

By JOSEPH PISANI

Early adopters of Apple's Vision Pro headsets have one thing to show for the year they've spent with their pricey purchases: regret.

"It's just collecting dust," Dustin Fox said about his mixed-reality headset, which looks like futuristic ski goggles. "I think I've probably used it four times in the last year."

The \$3,500 device sits in a bin with other gadgets he no longer picks up.

The Vision Pro launched in February 2024 with great promise. It was Apple's first major product release in years! It's the first device you look through and not at! Typing can be done in the air! But buyers who wore them in the wild say they got nothing but dirty looks and sore necks. Now, the devices are daily re-

mindings of their misplaced bravado.

Fox, a realtor in Centreville, Va., had to have the Vision Pro as soon as it launched. "I'm like a little boy when something new comes out," he said.

The 46-year-old thought he'd use it for work. Then he put it on his head.

"It's way too heavy," Fox said about the device, which weighs just over a pound. "I can't wear it for more than 20 or 30 minutes without it hurting my neck."

Tovia Goldstein was excited to wear his set to watch movies and TV shows. But he ended up needing breaks. "After 60 minutes, you can't, you just have to throw it down," he said. He hasn't touched it in about four months.

Weight isn't the only issue for the 24-year-old New

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Out of sight